

IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Document

Date	30 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-5397
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Team Size	5
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Team Members

Role	Name
Team Leader	LAVANYA S
Team Member	KAVIYA P
Team Member	KEERTHANA J
Team Member	LITHIKA P
Team Member	MADHUMITHA R

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

This document captures the team's ideation process for the project Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet). The goal is to identify a practical approach for importing spreadsheet data into a target system, mapping source columns to target fields, validating records, and reducing manual data-entry effort.

Problem Statement

Organizations often receive data in spreadsheets with inconsistent column names, formats, missing values, and duplicate records. Manually entering this information into a target application is time-consuming and can cause errors. A Transform Map based import process can automate field mapping, validation, transformation, and controlled loading of spreadsheet data.

Objective

- Import spreadsheet records into the required target table efficiently.
- Map source spreadsheet columns to the correct target fields.
- Validate and transform incoming values before creating or updating records.
- Identify invalid or duplicate records and provide clear error feedback.
- Make the import process repeatable and easy for team members to maintain.

Step 1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Problem Selection

The team discussed common difficulties in spreadsheet-to-system data entry and selected the following problem as the focus of the project.

Selected Problem	How can spreadsheet data be imported into a target system accurately and efficiently u
Target Users	System administrators, data-entry teams, project teams, and business users who regula
Expected Outcome	A structured import process that reduces manual work, improves data quality, and provi

Key Rules for Brainstorming

1	Encourage every team member to contribute ideas.
2	Focus on the problem before evaluating solutions.
3	Avoid rejecting ideas during the initial brainstorming stage.
4	Build on useful ideas and combine similar suggestions.
5	Prioritize ideas later using impact and feasibility.

Team Collaboration Notes

The team agreed that the import workflow should be simple enough for repeated use. Members contributed ideas around spreadsheet preparation, column mapping, data validation, transformation rules, duplicate detection, error handling, and reporting.

Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

The following ideas were generated and grouped into practical solution areas.

Spreadsheet Preparation

- Use a standard spreadsheet template.
- Keep column headers consistent.
- Check mandatory fields before upload.
- Remove unnecessary blank rows and columns.

Field Mapping

- Create a source-to-target field mapping table.
- Map each spreadsheet column to the corresponding target field.
- Document fields that require transformation.

Validation & Transformation

- Validate mandatory and data-type fields.
- Normalize dates, phone numbers, and text values.
- Apply default values where appropriate.
- Reject records with critical validation errors.

Duplicate Handling

- Identify records using a unique key.
- Decide whether matching records should be updated or skipped.
- Log duplicate records for review.

Error Handling & Reporting

- Provide import success and failure counts.
- Record row-level error messages.
- Allow users to correct failed rows and re-import them.

Testing & Maintenance

- Test with sample data before production import.
- Keep mapping and transformation rules documented.
- Review the process when spreadsheet structure changes.

Grouped Solution Themes

Group	Main Focus
A	Spreadsheet preparation and standardization
B	Source-to-target field mapping
C	Validation and data transformation
D	Duplicate detection and record handling
E	Error reporting, testing, and maintenance

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

Ideas were considered using two dimensions: expected importance/impact and practical feasibility. The priority areas below are intended to guide the prototype and implementation.

Priority Area	Importance	Feasibility	Reason
Field Mapping	High	High	Core requirement for connecting spreadsheet columns to target system.
Validation & Transformation	High	High	Improves data quality and prevents incorrect values from being imported.
Duplicate Handling	High	Medium	Helps avoid repeated records and supports controlled updates.
Error Reporting	High	High	Makes failed imports easier to identify and correct.
Spreadsheet Template	Medium	High	Reduces formatting issues before data reaches the import process.
Testing & Documentation	Medium	High	Supports repeatability and easier maintenance.

Recommended Prototype Flow

1	Prepare spreadsheet	Use standard headers, required fields, and clean values.
2	Load spreadsheet	Upload/import the source data into the staging/import area.
3	Apply Transform Map	Map source fields to target fields and define transformation rules.
4	Validate & transform	Check values, normalize formats, and handle missing/invalid data.
5	Create or update records	Load valid records while handling duplicates according to defined rules.
6	Review results	Check success/failure counts and correct rejected records.

Final Idea Summary

The team identified spreadsheet standardization, field mapping, validation, transformation, duplicate handling, and error reporting as the main components of the proposed solution. The prioritization exercise provides a clear direction for developing and demonstrating the Transform Map based import workflow.

Project	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Primary Goal	Accurate and efficient spreadsheet-to-system data import
Key Components	Mapping, validation, transformation, duplicate handling, reporting
Expected Benefit	Less manual entry, better data quality, and repeatable imports

Team Declaration

We confirm that the above brainstorming and prioritization document represents the team's proposed approach for the project and will be used as the basis for further design, implementation, testing, and demonstration.

Team Leader	Team Members
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